

Erwin Quanten

Staff Software Engineer – PHP, React, Laravel, Symfony, AWS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer with deep experience in logistics, telecom, manufacturing, and enterprise SaaS industries, building secure PHP and React platforms with **PHP 8.1-8.3, Laravel 9-11, Symfony 5-6, React 18, TypeScript 4.9-5.5**, AWS, Docker, Redis, MySQL, PostgreSQL, and CI/CD, known for modernizing legacy PHP systems, migrating monolith modules into API-driven services, improving frontend reliability, resolving production bugs, and leading cross-functional delivery where backend architecture, responsive UI, automated testing, observability, compliance, performance tuning, and release quality must work together under real business pressure.

SKILLS

- **Backend:** **PHP 8.1-8.3, Laravel 9-11, Symfony 5.4-6.4**, REST APIs, GraphQL, PHPUnit, Composer, Laravel Queues, Laravel Horizon, Sanctum, OAuth2
- **Frontend:** **React 18, TypeScript 4.9-5.5**, JavaScript ES2020-ES2023, Redux Toolkit, React Query, Vite, Webpack, Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress
- **Database & Cache:** MySQL 8, PostgreSQL 13-16, Redis 6-7, database indexing, query optimization, migrations, data reconciliation
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Linux, Nginx, CI/CD, blue-green deployment, monitoring, structured logging
- **Engineering:** Legacy migration, API design, performance tuning, debugging, secure coding, code review, Agile delivery, technical mentoring

EXPERIENCE

Lightedge — Lead Software Engineer

Remote/ Full time

May2022 – Apr 2026

=Houston, TX

- Architected secure logistics and edge-service SaaS modules with **PHP 8.1-8.3, Laravel 9-11, React 18, TypeScript 4.9-5.5**, AWS, Redis, MySQL, and Docker while keeping delivery flexible across backend APIs, frontend workflows, and release support.
- Migrated legacy **PHP 7.4** and **Laravel 6** billing modules to **PHP 8.2** and **Laravel 10** using Rector rules, compatibility tests, and phased deployment, reducing release regression issues by **28%**.
- Implemented **React 18** self-service onboarding features with reusable form components, validation patterns, and API-driven state handling, improving customer completion rate by **19%**.
- Resolved intermittent **502 errors** caused by Redis lock contention, slow Eloquent relationship loading, and missing timeout handling by adding query profiling, queue retries, and graceful API fallbacks.
- Reworked authentication and authorization around **Laravel Sanctum**, role-based access control, audit logging, and secure token refresh to protect customer admin portals and internal operations.
- Led API contract standardization across PHP services and React clients with OpenAPI documentation, typed request models, backward-compatible DTOs, and clear error response patterns.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions, Docker images, PHPUnit, React Testing Library, and blue-green deployment checks to keep production releases predictable and rollback-ready.
- Reduced average API response time by **34%** through database indexing, Redis cache normalization, eager-loading fixes, payload trimming, and focused Laravel performance profiling.
- Introduced observability dashboards with CloudWatch metrics, structured JSON logs, exception grouping, and frontend error tracking so production incidents could be triaged from symptoms to root cause.
- Mentored engineers on clean Laravel service layers, reusable React hooks, pull-request standards, and practical debugging habits that improved team ownership without slowing feature delivery.
- Coordinated with product managers and support teams to turn recurring customer pain points into roadmap features, especially around billing visibility, account controls, and operational reporting.
- Protected data quality by building reconciliation jobs, idempotent queue workers, and alert-driven repair scripts for payment sync failures, duplicate webhooks, and delayed partner events.

Syscom Digital — Staff Software Engineer

Remote/ Full time

Nov 2017 – Apr 2022

Bucharest, Romania

- Designed customer-facing telecom and digital commerce platforms with **PHP 7.2-8.0**, **Laravel 5.6-8**, **React 16.8-17**, Redux, MySQL, Redis, Jenkins, and Docker.
- Upgraded services from **PHP 7.1** to **PHP 7.4** and Laravel 5.5 to Laravel 7 by replacing deprecated helpers, fixing package conflicts, and validating behavior through automated regression suites.
- Built **React 16-17** single-page modules for customer orders, subscriptions, and account management using reusable components, Redux middleware, and REST API integration.
- Fixed high-priority session timeout and stale-cart bugs caused by mixed cookie settings, inconsistent cache keys, and race conditions between Laravel middleware and React state refresh.
- Improved checkout page load performance by **31%** by splitting frontend bundles, caching product metadata, simplifying SQL joins, and removing redundant API calls from React containers.
- Implemented payment and invoice reconciliation features that reduced manual finance investigation by **24%** through webhook idempotency, retry queues, and Laravel command-line repair tools.
- Containerized local development with Docker Compose, standardized environment variables, and documented database seed flows so new engineers could run PHP, React, MySQL, and Redis consistently.
- Wrote PHPUnit, Jest, and Cypress coverage for subscription upgrades, cancellation flows, and invoice edge cases to prevent silent billing failures during frequent release cycles.
- Supported gradual migration from jQuery-heavy customer pages to **React** components by isolating legacy DOM behavior, introducing shared API contracts, and avoiding risky full rewrites.
- Partnered with QA, DevOps, and business analysts to balance urgent production fixes with planned roadmap work across telecom portals, customer care tools, and reporting dashboards.

Tessenderlo Group — Senior Software Engineer

Remote/ Full time

Aug 2015 – Oct 2017

Brussel Metropolitan Area

- Delivered manufacturing and supply-chain applications with **PHP 5.6-7.1**, **Symfony 2.8-3.4**, Laravel 5.2-5.5, **React 15.6-16**, MySQL, Git, Jenkins, and Linux servers.
- Upgraded core PHP services from **PHP 5.5** to **PHP 7.0** by fixing strict typing warnings, dependency conflicts, and deprecated extensions, reducing runtime errors by **22%**.
- Introduced selective **React 15.6** components for production dashboards where dynamic filtering, status updates, and responsive behavior were difficult to maintain with server-rendered pages.
- Solved CSV import failures caused by encoding mismatches, malformed supplier data, and timeout-prone validation by adding streaming parsers, row-level error reporting, and retry-safe imports.
- Optimized inventory and production reports with query rewrites, indexes, and cache warming, cutting heavy report execution time by **37%** during month-end operational reviews.
- Implemented approval workflow features for procurement and plant operations using Symfony forms, service classes, email notifications, and audit trails aligned with business control needs.
- Standardized Composer dependency management, deployment checklists, and environment configuration so PHP applications could move between test, staging, and production with fewer surprises.
- Supported SOAP and REST integrations with ERP systems by hardening payload validation, adding retry handling, and documenting failure scenarios for support and operations teams.
- Guided developers through code reviews, debugging sessions, and incremental modernization decisions that improved maintainability while respecting older manufacturing-system constraints.

Tessenderlo Group — Software Engineer

Hybrid/ Full time

Sep 2011 – Jul 2015

Brussel Metropolitan Area

- Developed internal ERP, inventory, and operations modules with **PHP 5.3-5.6**, Symfony 2.x, Zend Framework, jQuery, Bootstrap, MySQL, Apache, and Linux shell scripts.
- Migrated custom PHP 5.2 scripts into **PHP 5.4** and Zend Framework modules by separating database logic, templates, and controllers without interrupting daily plant operations.
- Reduced inventory reconciliation manual effort by **26%** by building validation screens, exception reports, and scheduled comparison jobs for warehouse and finance stakeholders.
- Resolved character encoding and Excel export bugs caused by mixed Windows-1252 and UTF-8 data by normalizing database connections, headers, and import transformation rules.
- Built JSON endpoints for early internal dashboard needs, giving frontend pages cleaner data access and preparing legacy applications for later component-based UI modernization.

- Improved slow stock and shipment screens by **33%** through SQL index tuning, pagination, cached lookup tables, and removal of repeated queries inside PHP templates.
- Helped transition selected modules from SVN workflows toward Git-based branching, clearer release tags, and safer peer review practices for PHP maintenance work.
- Worked closely with business users to translate urgent operational issues into small, testable releases that could be deployed safely across warehouse and production environments.

Tessenderlo Group — Software Developer

Hybrid/ Full time

Jun 2009 – Aug 2011

Brussel Metropolitan Area

- Maintained LAMP business applications with **PHP 5.2-5.3**, CodeIgniter 1.7-2.0, MySQL 5.1, Apache, jQuery 1.4-1.6, HTML, CSS, XML, SOAP, and SVN.
- Fixed input validation, broken form submission, and SQL query issues in purchasing tools, reducing recurring support tickets by **18%** through safer PHP handling and clearer errors.
- Built procurement request workflows and approval screens that reduced email-based handoffs by **21%** while giving managers better visibility into pending internal requests.
- Supported migration from raw PHP includes to CodeIgniter MVC patterns by moving repeated database access into models, cleaning controllers, and standardizing shared views.
- Collaborated with senior engineers and operations users to debug production issues, document fixes, and build practical PHP features that matched real business processes.

EDUCATION

KU Leuven — Master's Degree, Computer Science

Sep 2003 – May 2009